

The Dream Boat

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Marin the mouse had a paper boat. He sailed it in his bathtub every night. It was white with a blue sail. Tonight, something felt different. The boat glowed faintly.

Marin felt curious. He touched the sail. It felt warm, like sunshine. "Are you magic?" he whispered.

The little boat bobbed. It seemed to nod. A tiny ladder dropped from its side. It was just Marin's size.



"Climb aboard, sailor," squeaked a tiny voice. It was a cricket wearing a captain's hat! "Tonight we sail to Dreamland."

Marin felt excited and a little nervous. But the cricket smiled kindly. Marin climbed the tiny ladder. The boat was bigger inside than outside. It had a cozy blanket and a pillow.

"Row, row, into dreams, past the moon and silver streams," sang the cricket captain.



The boat sailed out of the bathtub. It floated into the air! Marin gasped. Below him, his bedroom grew small. Above him, the stars grew close.

"Row, row, into dreams, past the moon and silver streams," sang the cricket again.

They sailed past the moon. The moon waved hello. They sailed past silver clouds. The clouds felt soft as cotton. Marin felt drowsy. The gentle rocking was lovely.



"Row, row, into dreams, past the moon and silver streams," sang the cricket one last time.

They arrived at Dreamland. It was a shore made of pillows. Trees grew candy stars. Marin stepped off the boat. He felt so sleepy he could barely stand.

The cricket tucked him into the pillow sand. It pulled a cloud over him like a blanket. "Sweet dreams, sailor," it whispered. "I will sail you home by morning."



Marin closed his eyes. The boat rocked gently beside him. He dreamed of sailing silver seas. He was the bravest little sailor in the world.

Sleep now, little sailor. Your dream boat will carry you home by morning. Dream of moonlit waves and starry skies.

Moral: *Imagination can turn an ordinary bath into an extraordinary voyage.*

The End